

Security Alert Notification and Escalation Procedure

COIT13236 | Security monitoring and incident response

SEC-03 | Version 1.0 | 9 September 2026

Owner: IT Administrator | Approval: _____ | Effective date: _____

Ensure security detections reach an accountable IT Administrator, receive a recorded acknowledgement and escalate when unattended. This procedure supplies the common routing and response targets for SEC-01, SEC-02, SEC-04 and SEC-05.

Operating baseline: approve the proposed thresholds and response targets before activation. Review each semester and after a significant incident or system change.

Routing and response targets

The following are proposed service targets, not measured service levels. Detection-to-notification time begins when a rule triggers. Acknowledgement time begins at notification dispatch. High and Critical targets require a staffed on-call arrangement; nominate coverage before activation.

Severity	Dispatch and acknowledgement	Escalation
Critical	Email and backup channel within 1 minute; acknowledge within 10 minutes	Backup and project lead at 10 minutes if unacknowledged
High	Email within 1 minute; acknowledge within 30 minutes	Backup at 30 minutes; project lead at 60 minutes if still unacknowledged
Medium	Email within 5 minutes; acknowledge within 4 business hours	Backup at 4 business hours; project lead next business day if still unowned
Low	Record immediately; daily digest; review next business day	IT Administrator raises severity if impact or recurrence increases

Business hours: Monday to Friday, 09:00 to 17:00 Australia/Brisbane, excluding local public holidays. High and Critical clocks run continuously. Promote severity immediately when new evidence increases impact; retain the original timestamps and escalation history.

Contact register

Primary IT Administrator name / email / phone: _____

Backup administrator name / email / phone: _____

Project lead name / email / phone: _____

Monitoring platform / incident register: _____

Approved backup notification channel: _____

Dispatch and escalation process

1. The central monitoring service creates an alert ID, severity and incident link, then dispatches to the contact register. Configure an authenticated mail relay with protected credentials and test delivery to the real administrator mailbox.
2. Include event time and timezone, receipt time, source system, user or unknown, client IP, event type, affected resource, rule and threshold, observed outcome, automatic action and evidence link. Never report containment unless it actually occurred.
3. The recipient explicitly acknowledges in the incident register, accepts ownership and records the next action. Mail delivery, an open tracking signal or a read receipt is not acknowledgement.
4. At the severity deadline, route to the backup or project lead as specified. Continue Critical reminders every 10 minutes and High reminders every 30 minutes until an owner accepts. Record each delivery attempt and escalation.
5. Correlate matching alerts for the same rule, user or host and resource into one open incident over 15 minutes. Preserve each event and count; a new resource, rising severity or continuing damage must still notify.
6. If email delivery fails, retry after 1, 5 and 15 minutes and use the backup channel immediately for High or Critical alerts. Monitor the notification service from an independent check so its own failure can be reported.
7. The incident owner supplies Critical updates every 30 minutes and High updates every 2 hours until contained. Follow the relevant technical procedure, record recovery tests, and notify recipients of closure and follow-up actions.

Ownership and communications

The IT Administrator coordinates technical response. The project lead coordinates service-impact communications and decides whether specialist or external reporting advice is needed. Keep operational details within approved recipients and use restricted incident links for sensitive evidence.

Alert template and acceptance test

Reusable alert template

Subject: SECURITY ALERT [Severity] [Alert ID] [Event type]

Event time and timezone: [value]

Detected / received: [value]

Source system / client IP: [value]

User / affected resource: [value or unknown]

Rule / count / window: [value]

Observed result: [blocked, denied, succeeded or unknown]

Automatic action: [action actually completed or none]

Incident and evidence link: [restricted link]

Acknowledge by: [date and time]

Required action: Accept ownership and begin the relevant response procedure.

End to end acceptance test

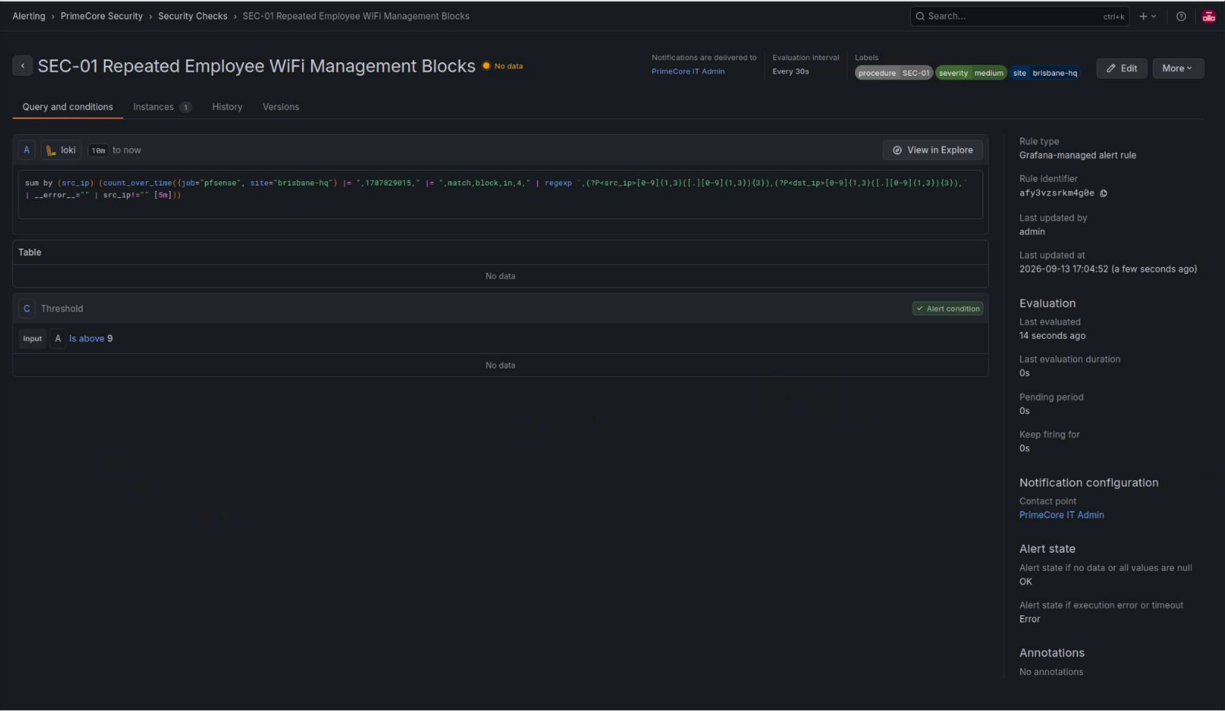
- Generate one controlled detection of each severity; verify timestamps, content, mailbox receipt and correct incident link.
- Leave a test alert unacknowledged and verify backup escalation and reminders at the stated deadlines. Mark all messages clearly as TEST.
- Acknowledge a test incident; verify reminders stop and the accepted owner is recorded.
- Interrupt the test mail route; verify retry records and the independent backup channel. Restore the route and reconcile queued alerts.
- Generate duplicate events and then increase severity; verify correlation retains evidence and the severity increase produces a new notification.

Record expected and actual times, recipients, evidence and pass or fail. Repeat after contact, rule, mail relay or monitoring changes and monthly during operation. Review overdue incidents each working day.

Screenshot evidence appendix

These figures record selected laboratory observations. They support the tested functions described in this artefact. Proposed policies, untested controls and organisational approval remain separate from the pictured results.

Figure E1 Scheduled alert settings

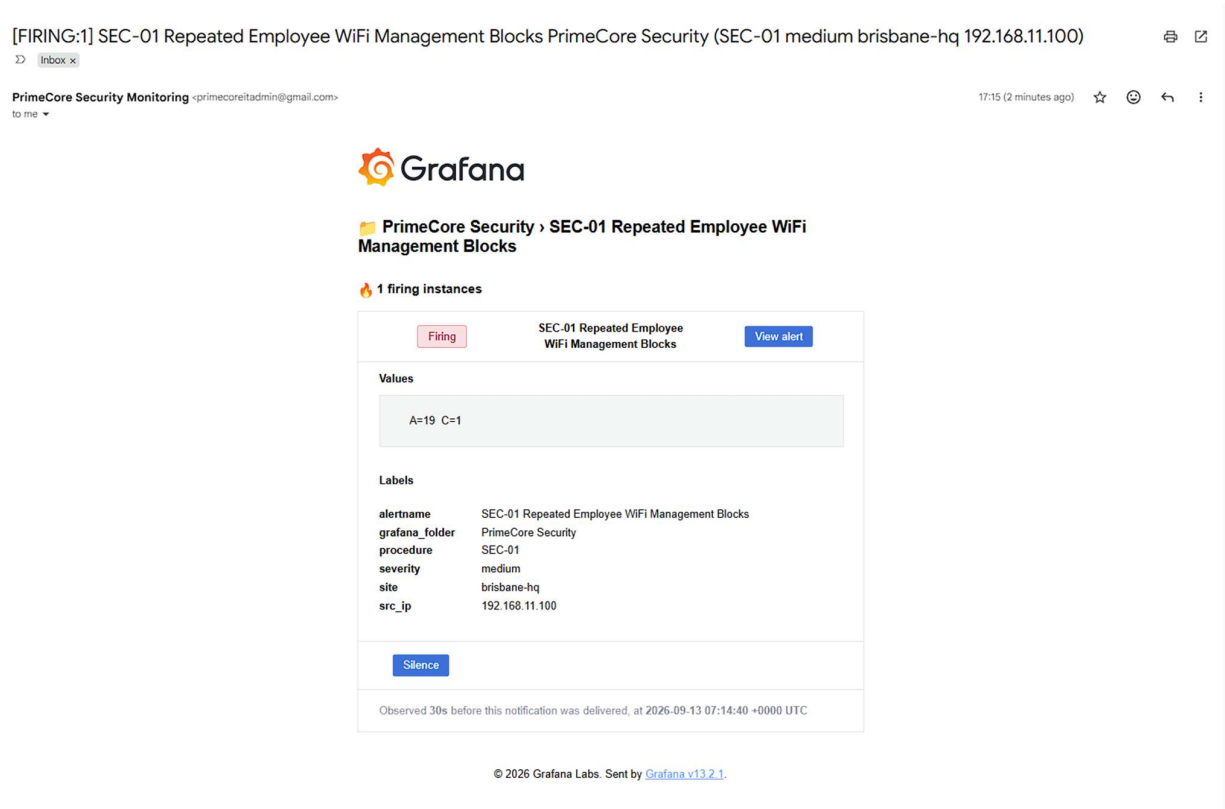


The alert evaluates every 30 seconds and uses a threshold above nine matching events. NoData is mapped to OK; this must not be interpreted as proof of collector health.

Source evidence: evidence/R06_Alert_Corrected_Settings.png

Screenshot evidence continued

Figure E2 Firing notification received

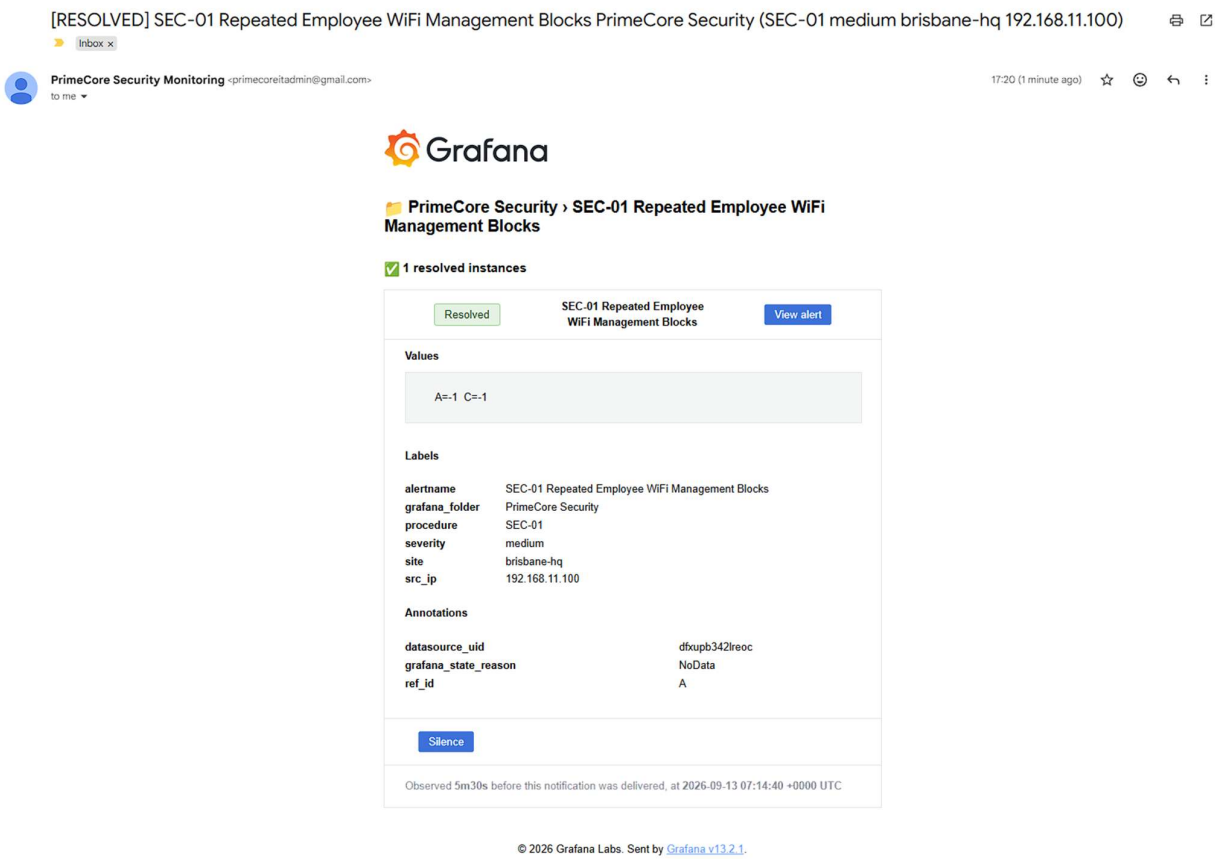


The rule-specific email reports A=19 and C=1 for source 192.168.11.100. Receipt demonstrates notification delivery, but not human acknowledgement or escalation.

Source evidence: evidence/R06_Firing_Email_Received.png

Screenshot evidence continued

Figure E3 Resolved notification received



The resolved email records NoData handling. A=-1 and C=-1 are state indicators, not negative event counts, and automated resolution does not close an incident.

Source evidence: evidence/R06_Resolved_Email_Received.png